THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

SpaceX lines up its first try at catching both halves of Starship

Elon Musk opened the weekend by announcing that SpaceX will try to catch both the Super Heavy booster and the Starship upper stage on its next flight, which SpaceX now targets for Friday, November 13. Hours later he spent an hour on stage, by video link, with investor Ron Baron, laying out plans for Terafab chip making, Starmind computers in orbit and a much faster Starlink. Over the weekend he said the Cybertruck order backlog is larger than Tesla can build before the line closes, so many deposits will be refunded. He also promised overnight fixes after Grok Bot subscribers complained about running out of usage.

I · STARSHIP

"First time that all parts of an orbital rocket return"

Flight 15 is set to attempt a catch of the booster minutes after launch and of the ship nearly a day later, after it deploys Starlink V3 satellites.

Nov 13	26	~22.5 hr
Earliest launch date for Flight 15, pending regulatory approval	Starlink V3 satellites the ship is planned to deploy	Planned time from liftoff to the ship catch at Starbase

At 10:47 a.m. EST Friday, Musk wrote: "SpaceX will attempt to catch both the Super Heavy booster and Starship on the upcoming flight. If both are successful, it will mark the first time that all parts of an orbital rocket return to Earth intact. This is the critical breakthrough needed to make life multiplanetary."

The SpaceX mission page lists a 75-minute window opening at 5:45 p.m. EST on November 13. The booster catch is scheduled about 6 minutes 35 seconds after liftoff; it is the first return and catch attempt for a V3 Super Heavy. The ship is to deploy 26 Starlink V3 satellites and return to Starbase for a tower catch about 22 hours 32 minutes after launch, but only if the flight team confirms the systems for reentry, the landing burn and the tower approach are healthy. Quartz reported that the ship should fly at about 275 km and complete about 14 orbits.

ON THE WIRE

Bigger engines. Musk said a 500-ton-thrust Raptor 4 is "so tempting" for the booster's outer ring, in place of the 250-ton Raptor 3 (post).



A Super Heavy booster fires its engines beside the launch tower at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

On Saturday at 11:54 a.m. EST, Musk added "Catching a giant rocket falling from space" over a SpaceX update that Flight 15 "is targeting to launch as early as Friday, November 13, pending regulatory approval." When SpaceX engineer Shana Diez joked about launching on Friday the 13th, he replied: "Fate does love irony, so perhaps the unluckiest day will actually be the luckiest."

Raptor 4 at 500 tons?

At 8:39 p.m. EST Friday Musk mused: "It is so tempting to make a 500 ton thrust Raptor 4 in place of the 250 ton Raptor 3 for the outer ring of the Starship booster." On Sunday night he answered an explainer on why Super Heavy uses 33 engines while Saturn V used five: "33 engines means we can lose a few and still complete the mission. Also, beyond a certain physical size, parts fabrication and transport become much more expensive."

II · BARON INVESTMENT CONFERENCE

Terafab, Starmind and a faster Starlink

In an hour-long fireside chat with Ron Baron in New York on Friday, Musk described chip fabs in Texas, computers in orbit and laser links meant to compete with undersea cables, then kept the themes going on X.

Q3 2027	10 Tb/s	1 GW+
When Musk guessed the first Starmind computers will launch	Speed Musk gave for next-generation Starlink laser links	Output of the Memphis power plant Musk said was built in about a year

Musk appeared by video link at the 33rd Annual Baron Investment Conference, where the fireside chat was scheduled for 1:10 p.m. EST. "The pitchfork level for data centers is pretty high," he said at the start, according to InvestmentNews. He said a satellite carrying an NVIDIA GPU and another carrying a Google TPU are "working fine in space," and that SpaceX expects to start launching its first Starmind computers, co-designed with NVIDIA, "probably – I'm just guessing here – but in the 3rd quarter of next year," ramping in 2028 and to "very, very large volume in '29." At 4:05 p.m. EST he added on X: "When we unveil the details of the Starmind computer next year, it will blow people's minds."

On revenue, Tesla North quoted him saying the combined SpaceX and xAI business is "tracking to have an annual rate of revenue that is in excess of 100 billion dollars in December," with a guess that the run rate could pass $500 billion by December 2027, which he called "not a promise."

A research fab for Terafab

Musk said Tesla is building a research fab at Gigafactory Texas to try new chip processes before moving them to the larger Terafab plant planned for Grimes County, and that "something that would normally take a year, I think we may be able to reduce to a month," Tesla North reported. That evening he posted, "If you want to iterate fast with radically new chip designs, join the Terafab project!" He also replied to an X Freeze summary saying wafers can spend as little as 20% of their time being processed: "If the wafer is transported in vacuum, then no pump down is required when it transfers to a machine that requires vacuum. This would greatly improve cycle time and yield."

Starlink V4 and laser links

Quoting a clip in which he said Starlink V4 will have 10 times the capability of V3, with 10-terabit laser links, Musk wrote at 2:32 p.m. EST: "~100 lasers per satellite, each operating above 10 Tb/s, with over 100k satellites should be able to outcompete undersea cables. Speed of light in space is ~40% faster than cable and the path is direct, instead of following the outline of land masses." He later told Philip Johnston that smaller lasers, "10X closer proximity" and a small gimbal angle for in-plane links might make 100 lasers per satellite possible.

> *"Information traveling through space in our solar system will ultimately exceed current Earth traffic by a trillion trillion times. People have no idea."*
>
> ELON MUSK · 8:09 P.M. EST FRIDAY

ON THE WIRE

Starmind timing. Musk guessed the first Starmind computers, co-designed with NVIDIA, will launch in the third quarter of next year, per InvestmentNews.

Agents, Memphis and "no upstairs"

In the interview Musk said agentic internet traffic already exceeds human traffic, and that Cloudflare's prediction of a thousandfold increase in five years may be "underestimating," according to a clip he quote-posted: "Roughly doubling revenue at scale for a large company used to be something special, but super intelligence makes that look slow!" He told Baron he lives in an Airstream parked next to the Memphis power plant, which he said produces "over a gigawatt" and was built "in about a year." On X he wrote: "Armies that win have the general at the front lines. Nobody wants to bleed for the prince in the palace." He endorsed his own remark that Memphis "is booming" because of SpaceX's data center and that opposition to data centers is "a temporary concern."

QUICK HIT

Legacy. Asked by the 83-year-old Baron how he wants to be remembered, Musk said he hoped he "made a significant contribution in the furtherance of civilization," Tesla North reported.

ON THE WIRE

Run rate. Musk said the combined SpaceX and xAI business is tracking to an annual revenue rate above $100 billion in December, per Tesla North.

III · SPACEX & STARLINK

Bigger than NASA's budget, and a Google director steps down

Musk compared SpaceX's quarterly revenue with NASA's annual budget, explained a board departure, welcomed a 5G partner and shared three Starlink rescues.

At 12:46 p.m. EST Friday Musk wrote, "SpaceX revenue this quarter alone will be substantially higher than NASA's entire annual budget!" That evening he noted that the "NASA FY2027 budget request is ~$18.8B." Earlier, responding to a suggestion that he offer to cancel federal contracts critics object to, he said Tesla has no government contracts, that "government revenue will be less than 10% of SpaceX revenue this quarter and less then 5% a year from now," and "Happy to cancel any that the government doesn't want."

Don Harrison leaves the board

SpaceX announced that Don Harrison, Google's president of global partnerships and corporate development and a director since February 2015, stepped down effective November 4. Its 8-K says the resignation "was not due to any disagreement with the Company." At 8:46 p.m. EST Friday Musk wrote: "Don has been a great board member. Very much appreciate his contributions. At this point, there are simply too many conflicts of interest with Alphabet, so he decided to step down." On Saturday he called "Interesting" a DogeDesigner post saying Alphabet held 555 million SpaceX shares worth $83.7 billion at Sept. 30, a stake CNA reported rose from 551.2 million.

Qualcomm and Starlink Mobile

At 10:15 p.m. EST Sunday Musk wrote, "Excited to be working with @Qualcomm on breakthrough technologies for 5G & beyond," quoting Qualcomm CEO Cristiano Amon, who said it is "going to be one of the largest 5G deployments in the United States." CNBC reported Wednesday that SpaceX will use Qualcomm's Dragonwing hardware and software in base stations for Starlink Mobile under a multiyear deal, with rollout planned to begin next year.

> **QUICK HIT**
> **Anthropic compute.** When a clip of Chamath Palihapitiya argued SpaceX could reprice its compute deal with Anthropic if supply tightens, Musk replied: "If compute becomes plentiful and cheap, SpaceX revenue will drop. No crying in the casino for either party."

Starlink rescues

Musk posted "Starlink saves lives" three times. On Friday he shared DogeDesigner's account of the Estonian yacht Cekritito, which sank off Spain after Captain Madis Rallmann used Starlink to alert volunteer rescuers in Estonia; a Spanish Coast Guard helicopter lifted all six sailors to Vigo. On Saturday he highlighted Starlink kits arriving in Tado, an earthquake-hit village in Indonesia, and on Sunday he shared a report that five people stranded about 15 km from Kystau Kurchum, Kazakhstan, used Starlink to reach rescuers.

Compute in orbit

Musk said "Larry Page has made many accurate predictions and this is one of them" over a report that the Google co-founder expects "five-nines," or 99.999%, of computing to end up in space. He answered "Yup" to a summary of his claim that 100 GW a year of orbital AI compute at $10 per watt would add $1 trillion in annual revenue. He also wrote "Super intelligence leads to abundance" over a Cochise County, Arizona, supervisor's remark that SpaceX's data center there could cut county property taxes by as much as 20%.

IV · TESLA

Cybertruck orders outrun the line's last months

Tesla will add a shift to build as many trucks as it can before the line is dismantled for Cybercab, but many deposits will be returned.

~8 mo	40 kWh	Nov 20
Time left before the Cybertruck line shuts down, per Musk on Monday	Cybercab battery pack Musk said efficiency gains will allow	Tesla's launch date in Argentina

At 1:12 p.m. EST Saturday Musk wrote: "The Tesla Cybertruck order backlog is currently far more than we can make before dismantling the line for Cybercab expansion around June/July next year. We will add an extra shift to try to get all orders done in time." Hours earlier he had told Robert Scoble that Tesla is "still building Cybertruck for another 8 or 9 months," adding, "There will never be another vehicle like it."

At 2:20 a.m. EST Monday he went further: "We will try to make as many as possible before shutting down the line in about 8

months, but will have to return deposits for a lot of people. This is not a case of Cybertruck being unprofitable, as has been misreported by legacy media, but rather that the opportunity cost of the complexity of Cybertruck is vastly outweighed by the value of incremental Cybercab production." Reuters noted that US Cybertruck sales fell 48% last year to 20,237, according to Kelley Blue Book. Asked why Tesla does not simply build more factory space, Musk said high-volume factories are extremely hard to build: "Prototypes are trivial by comparison."



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, where the Cybertruck is built, shown on June 17, 2022.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

A 40 kWh Cybercab pack in liquid silver

Replying to a post comparing battery use in a large SUV and a robotaxi, Musk wrote on Saturday: "There are efficiency improvements coming that will allow for a 40kWh Cybercab pack. We will make this in liquid silver, so the colors are not too monotonous."

Model Y at the top

Musk called the Model Y "the best-selling car of any kind on Earth" over a post that Tesla sold 39,035 Model Ys in Australia from January through October against 35,927 Toyota RAV4s. On Saturday he added that "the second and third best-selling cars are much cheaper."

Tesla comes to Argentina

At 2:27 p.m. EST Friday Musk cheered "Tesla Argentina!!" over Tesla Latinoamérica's "Llegamos a Argentina el 20 de Noviembre" ("We arrive in Argentina on November 20," translated). La Nación reported the first store will be in the Unicenter mall in Martínez, showing two cars, with a ten-car test-drive area.

V · AI & NEURALINK

Overnight fixes for Grok Bot

After subscribers said their usage ran out within hours, Musk promised token-efficiency fixes.

The thread began with a question about what to do when Grok Bot runs out of usage; Musk asked, "Is it not one-click-easy to increase usage?" A user replied that a $200 plan that lasted seven days "full throttle" the week before now lasted 14 hours under moderate load. At 8:01 a.m. EST Sunday Musk said "I will dig into this today," asked whether the product offers "an easy way to shift to per token pricing," and at 8:17 a.m. posted: "Grok Bot fixes for improved token efficiency and smarter behavior are underway."

> *"Just did a round table review with the Grok @Bot engineering team. Fixes are being implemented overnight and you should notice a dramatic improvement by tomorrow."*
> ELON MUSK · 9:25 P.M. EST SUNDAY

Neuralink

At 8:53 p.m. EST Friday Musk wrote, "In the coming years, @Neuralink will enable people to walk and use their hands again," over a clip of patient Noland Arbaugh.

Takeaways

1. SpaceX targets November 13 for Starship Flight 15, its first attempt to catch both the booster and the ship.
2. Musk guessed the first Starmind computers will launch in the third quarter of 2027.
3. Google's Don Harrison left the SpaceX board; Musk cited conflicts of interest with Alphabet.
4. Cybertruck orders exceed what Tesla can build before the line closes; many deposits will be refunded.
5. Musk promised overnight Grok Bot fixes for usage limits.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @SpaceX, @ShanaDiez, @iam_smx, @SawyerMerritt, @XFreeze, @KanekoaTheGreat, @cb_doge, @WR4NYGov, @rohanpaul_ai, @hosun_chung, @niccruzpatane, @firesidealpha, @Tesla_LatAm, @Texas_Twins_Dad, @dneighbors and @teslaownersSV.

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